

Essential Lesson Highlights: Grammar Refresher

This comprehensive overview summarizes key points and concepts from the Grammar Refresher series, covering various aspects of English grammar essential for interpreters.

Section 1: Nouns, Adjectives, Pronouns

Nouns

Represent people, places, things, ideas, and feelings.

Example: *Judy* is calling the *bank* about her *statement*.



Common Nouns

General things (examples: banker, country, report, love, unease)



Proper Nouns

Specific names (examples: Judy, China, New York Stock Exchange)



Countable Nouns

Quantifiable using "many, few" (examples: many *transactions*, a few *clients*, ten *medications*)



Uncountable Nouns

Quantifiable using "much, little" (examples: much *information*, a little *advice*, so much *medication*)



Compound Nouns

Two or more words combined which represent a new meaning (examples: credit card, customer service, bookshelf, motherboard, cell phone)

Adjectives

Describe or modify nouns.

Example: *My oldest account has been in good standing for nearly twenty years.*



Descriptive Adjectives

Describe qualities or states (examples: accurate, comprehensive).



Quantitative Adjectives

Indicate how much (examples: several, many, fifty).



Demonstrative Adjectives

Refer to specific items (examples: this, those).



Possessive Adjectives

Show ownership (examples: my, your, his, her, its, our, your, their).



Interrogative Adjectives

Ask questions (examples: which, what, whose).



Distributive Adjectives

Indicate individual members of a group of items (examples: each, every, either, neither).



Comparative and Superlative Adjectives

Compare items (examples: higher, highest, smaller, smallest).

Pronouns

Stand in place of nouns or refer to nouns.

Example: *We have given ourselves enough time for our meeting. It will begin soon.*



Subject Pronouns

Replace the subject (examples: I, you, he, she, it, we, you, they). Example: "She will process your request."



Object Pronouns

Replace the direct or indirect object (examples: me, us, you, him, her, it, them). Example: "The advisor helped them."



Possessive Pronouns

Show ownership (examples: mine, ours, yours, his, hers, its, theirs). Example: "The final decision is theirs."



Reflexive Pronouns

Indicate the subject acts on itself (examples: myself, ourselves). Example: "I prepared myself for the meeting."



Demonstrative Pronouns

Point to specific nouns (examples: this, that, these, those). Example: "These are the documents you requested."

Section 2:

Verbs, Adverbs, Verb Tenses, Modal Verbs

Verbs

Show action, state, or occurrence.

Example: The librarian asked the students to return their books at the service desk.



Infinitives

Unconjugated verbs with "to" (examples: to verify)



Regular Verbs

Follow standard conjugation (examples: deposit, deposited).



Irregular Verbs

Do not follow standard rules (examples: be, was, been).

Adverbs

Modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs.

Example: Her diligent insurance agent responded promptly and accurately to her urgent request.



Adverbs of Manner

Indicate how an action is performed (examples: quickly, accurately).



Adverbs of Time

Indicate when an action occurs (examples: now, later).



Adverbs of Place

Indicate where an action occurs (examples: here, there).



Adverbs of Degree

Indicate intensity (examples: very, completely).



Adverbs of Frequency

Indicate how often an action occurs (examples: always, never).

Verb Tenses

Indicate if the action occurs in the past, present, or future and if it is ongoing or completed.

Example: The detective *is interrogating* the suspect. vs. The detective *interrogated* the suspect.



Present Simple

Regular activities and facts
Example: The bank opens at 9 AM.



Present Continuous

Actions happening now
Example: The manager is reviewing the application.



Past Simple

Completed actions
Example: The client signed the contract.



Past Continuous

Ongoing actions in the past
Example: The customer was explaining the issue when the call disconnected.



Future Simple

Actions that will happen
Example: The loan officer will contact you tomorrow.



Future Continuous

Actions in progress in the future
Example: We will be processing your request this afternoon.



Going to Future

Planned actions
Example: I am going to submit the report.



Present Perfect

Actions with relevance to the present
Example: The analyst has reviewed the data.



Past Perfect

Actions completed before another action
Example: The client had left before the advisor arrived.



Future Perfect

Actions completed before a specific future time
Example: The team will have completed the audit by Friday.

Modal Verbs

Express abilities, permissions, possibilities, and obligations.

Example: Wanda's supervisor must first approve the changes.



Can

Ability or permission

Example: You can access your account online.



Could

Past ability or polite permission

Example: Could you send the documents?



May

Permission or possibility

Example: You may qualify for a lower interest rate.



Might

Possibility

Example: The transaction might take longer to process.



Must

Obligation or necessity

Example: You must sign the form.



Should

Advice or recommendation

Example: You should check your balance regularly.



Will

Future intention or certainty

Example: The agent will assist you shortly.



Would

Polite request or hypothetical situation

Example: Would you like to schedule an appointment?

Section 3:

Articles, Conjunctions, Prepositions, Interjections

Articles

Define nouns as definite (specific) or indefinite (unspecific).

Example: The company uses an onboarding agency to assist when hiring a new employee.



Definite Article:

"The" refers to specific nouns.

Example: The application is complete.



Indefinite Articles

"A" and "An" refer to non-specific nouns.

Example: An advisor will give you a document.

Conjunctions

Connect words, phrases, or clauses.

Example: I want to buy a new computer, but my old one is still functioning well.



Coordinating Conjunctions

Link two independent clauses, which are groups of words that contain a subject and a verb and expresses a complete thought and can stand alone as a complete sentence (examples: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so).

Example: The account was overdrawn, but the issue was resolved.



Subordinating Conjunctions

Link dependent clauses to independent clauses. Dependent clauses are also called subordinate clauses. These are groups of words that contain a subject and a verb but do not express a complete thought. They cannot stand alone as a sentence but must be attached to an independent clause (examples: because, although, since, if).

Example: The loan was approved because all the required documents were submitted.



Correlative Conjunctions

Work in pairs (examples: both... and, either... or, neither... nor).

Example: You can either call us or visit the branch.

Prepositions

Show relationships between nouns or pronouns and other elements.

Example: Please install the software on your computer.



Types of Prepositions

- **Place:** in, on, at, under, above, between, behind, beside
- **Time:** at, on, in, before, after, during, until
- **Direction:** to, toward, into, through, across, over, from
- **Agent or Instrument:** by, with
- **Cause or Purpose:** for, because of, due to



Prepositional Phrases

Begin with a preposition and end with a noun or pronoun.

Examples: John works in the office. He takes notes during the meeting.

Interjections

Express sudden or strong emotions.

Example: Yikes! That's a difficult situation.



Interjections often stand alone.

Ah!, Oh!, Wow!, Ouch!, Hey!, Oops!, Yay!

Example: "Wow! That's an excellent rate."

Section 4:

Sentence Structures

Active and Passive Voice

Express whether the subject of the sentence is performing the action or being acted upon.

Example: Active – He filled out the forms.
Passive – The forms were completed.



Active Voice

The subject performs the action.

SUBJECT	PERFORMS THE ACTION	OBJECT
The banker	reviewed	the loan application.



Passive Voice

The subject receives the action.

SUBJECT	RECEIVES ACTION	PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE
The loan application	was reviewed	by the banker.

Subject-Verb Agreement

Ensures that subject and verb match in number, singular nouns with singular verbs and plural nouns with plural verbs.

Example: *Joseph speaks* English. vs. The *students speak* English.



Rules

Subjects and verbs must agree in number and person.

- **Singular subjects take singular verbs.**
Example: The policy covers all risks.
- **Plural subjects take plural verbs.**
Example: The policies cover all risks.
- **Subjects joined by “and” use a plural verb.**
Example: The agent and the client discuss the terms.
- **Subjects joined by “or” or “nor” agree with the closer subject.**
Example: Neither the agent nor the clients are satisfied.

Simple, Compound, and Complex Sentence Patterns

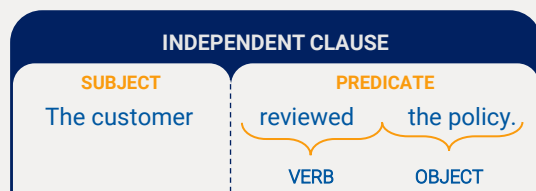
Allow the speaker to express one idea at a time or multiple connected ideas in a variety of patterns.

Examples: Simple – The sales representative sold the driver an auto insurance policy.
Compound – The appraiser inspected the damages, and the adjuster processed the claim.
Complex – The driver was relieved, because the repairs were completed.



Simple Sentences

Contain one independent clause.



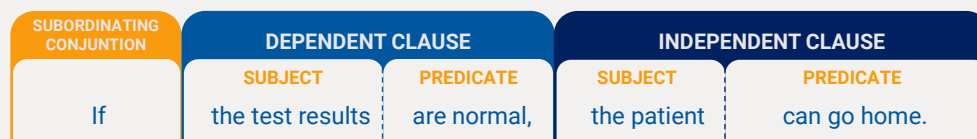
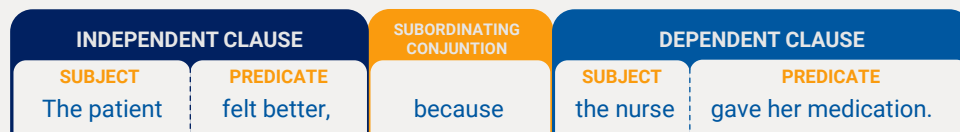
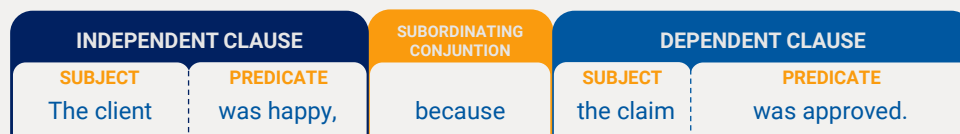
Compound Sentences

Contain two or more independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction.



Complex Sentences

Combine independent and dependent clauses using subordinating conjunctions.



Key Takeaways

By mastering these grammar concepts, interpreters can enhance their communication skills, which will contribute to more accurate, complete, and effective interpretation sessions.



- Nouns represent people, places, things, and ideas.
- Adjectives describe nouns.
- Pronouns replace nouns to avoid repetitiveness.
- Verbs indicate actions or states of being.
- Adverbs modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs.
- Present, past, and future verb tenses describe actions in different time frames.
- Modal verbs express abilities, permissions, possibilities, and obligations.
- Articles define nouns as definite or indefinite.
- Conjunctions connect ideas.
- Prepositions indicate relationships between sentence elements.
- Interjections express emotions or reactions.
- Active voice focuses on the subject doing the action.
- Passive voice focuses on the action or object of the sentence, when the subject is unimportant or unknown.
- Subject-verb agreement ensures grammatical accuracy.
- Simple, compound, and complex sentence structures add clarity and variety to your speech.